

Blueprint for Black Wealth

An overview of The Collective's shared objectives, strategic planning roadmap, and the micro- and macro-level goals. Our first step (aka planning session) to build wealth for Black business owners in Columbus, Ohio.

Outcomes of **Strategic Planning Session 1**: August 26, 2024

Hosted by: Freedom Equity Inc.

Facilitated by: Organized Synergy



The Columbus Black Wealth Collective Will...

Strategic Objectives



Create Generational Impact

We're here to drive lasting change for Black people and businesses, building a legacy of economic empowerment.



Build Our Power Hub

We're establishing a central force for information, resources, and strategic action, responsive to our community's unique needs and opportunities.



Craft Our Collective Agenda

We're developing a shared roadmap that defines how we work together, aligning our goals, language, and standards across all stakeholders.



Execute with Excellence

We're committed to turning our vision into reality through strategic planning, collaborative execution (the blueprint), and engagement at every level of influence.



Secure Our Fair Share

We're uniting to advocate for equitable policy and funding at scale, making bold asks across corporate, government, and foundation sectors.

Strategic Planning Roadmap

Between Now and Session 2 We Will...

Finalize the Entrepreneurial Journey Map

- **What:** Journey Map with stages of business development
- **When:** Draft sent 1 week prior to session 2/refined in session 2
- **Who:** OSOD to draft/The Collective to refine



Address Current and Emerging Needs

- **What:** Using WCEO's economic impact report and other insights, identify program/resource gaps at each stage of the entrepreneurial journey
- **When:** In session 2
- **Who:** The Collective



Map Providers at Each Stage of the Entrepreneurial Journey

- **What:** Using The U's ESO asset map, match resources to each stage of the entrepreneurial journey
- **When:** In session 2
- **Who:** The Collective



Prioritize Goals Based on Capacity (years 1-5)

- **What:** Identify and reaffirm the resources needed to continue and advance the work
- **When:** In session 2
- **Who:** The Collective to refine
- **Note:** OSOD to share the curated list from the assessment phase.



Finalize Capacity Needs to Achieve Goals

- **What:** Rank top 3-5 goals per pillar on which to focus The Collective's strategy and set targets.
- **When:** In session 2
- **Who:** The Collective



Select High-leverage Goals

- **What:** Of the 70 micro- and Macro-level goals identified in session 1, select those that align with the strategic objectives (slide 2) identified in session 1.
- **When:** Before session 2 (homework)
- **Who:** Each group member
- **Note:** goals on slides 4-10

Aligned Goals, Shared Success

Goal Framework for Sustainable, Measurable Black Economic Progress



The Visionary (business owner)

Goals for individual business owners focused on personal growth, financial security, and quality of life.



The Enterprise (business)

Business goals should be specific, measurable, and focused on the growth, sustainability, and operational excellence of the company.



The Village (ESO network)

Goals for ESOs focus on effectively supporting and empowering entrepreneurs and businesses in their ecosystem.



The Business Community (local economy)

Goals for the local economy should focus on broader economic indicators and community-wide impacts.



The Visionary

Cultivating... Ideas, Influence, and Quality of Life

Personal Growth and Education Goals

- Pursue continuous education and skill development
- Develop leadership skills
- Achieve personal milestones (e.g., becoming a multi-millionaire, build a family, etc.)
- Capacity for the work required to grow and sustain the business

Financial Security and Wealth Building Goals

- Achieve financial stability (1-year personal and 3-year operating reserves)
- Plan for long-term financial security (e.g., 15-year investments)
- Build personal wealth for household
- Achieve desired level of profit/sustainability based on self-determined success (i.e., sell the business/be acquired)
- Obtain a livable salary from the business
- Create a succession plan

Community Impact and Legacy Goals

- Create positive impact on community through contributions
- Build a strong professional network that increases exposure/opportunity
- Pay livable wages and create a corporate culture



Building... Generational Wealth & Impact

Revenue, Growth

- Increase annual revenue by X% year-over-year
- Achieve sustainable growth rate of X% per [year]
- Grow team by X [annually] while increasing revenue per employee

Market Expansion

- Develop and refine compelling pitch and capability statement
- Strive for target market perfection by increasing ideal customer acquisitions by X% and customer retention rate to X% in X year.
- Generate \$X revenue from corporate contracts by [end of fiscal year]

Operational Efficiency Goals

- Implement X new systems, processes, and policies to improve operational efficiency, scalability, and sustainability; and increase valuation
- Implement a system to measure and improve business responsiveness

Financial Management

- Establish a 3-year operations reserve fund of \$X
- Improve profit margins by X% within the next [fiscal year]
- Acquire X strategic assets or properties valued at \$Y within [XX months]
- Achieve comprehension and accuracy in financial reporting and key metrics

The Enterprise



Equipping...

Central Ohio's Black Businesses

Ecosystem Strengthening and Collaboration

- Align The Collective's vision with X partner organizations to create a stronger support ecosystem within [12 months]
- Establish a centralized agenda and communication channel among local ESOs, meeting [monthly] to align our efforts
- Develop and implement a shared impact measurement system across partner ESOs, evaluating our collective impact on the entrepreneurial ecosystem annually
- Enhance our role as liaisons and advocates, establishing X new partnerships with resource providers [this year]

Service Delivery and Innovation

- Implement a comprehensive support system based on the 5M Model (Motivation, Mentoring, Market Access, Management Education, and Money), ensuring that X% of our served businesses receive tailored assistance in at least X of these areas [within X months]
- Improve our ability to maintain business owner focus/attention by implementing a new client management system [this quarter]
- Develop X scalable, fundable program models that can be replicated by other ESOs within [X months]
- Facilitate the securing of X new government or corporate contracts for our supported businesses, with a total value of \$X, within the next [X months]

The Village

Equipping...

Central Ohio's Black Businesses



Organizational Capacity and Development

- Scale our organization's capacity to support X% more businesses within [X years]
- Increase our human capital by hiring and training X new staff members in key support roles [within X months]
- Increase our assets (equipment, facilities, etc.) by X% to better serve businesses in the next [year]
- Develop X new leadership programs for our staff in the next [X months]
- Develop an initiative for intergenerational collaboration
- Design and launch a 'healthy community' initiative

Funding and Resource Development

- Secure \$X in unrestricted resources for our operations in the next [fiscal year]
- Diversify our funding streams
- Create and pilot X innovative funding models to support operations and programs [within X years]

The Village



The Business Community

Advancing... Black Economic Prosperity

Employment and Income

- Increase Black employment rate by X% within X years
- Create X new jobs in Black-owned businesses annually

Business Growth and Attraction

- Increase Black-owned middle market companies by X% in X years
- Grow total number of Black-owned companies by X% year-over-year
- Attract X new Black-owned businesses to the area annually

Economic Participation and Influence

- Improve average credit ratings in Black communities by X points within X years
- Expand Black participation in local tax base by X% [annually]
- Recommend X new/revised policies annually to promote equitable economic growth and address systemic barriers

Innovation and Economic Growth

- Increase measures of innovation (e.g., patents filed, new business formations) in Black communities by X% annually



Advancing... Black Economic Prosperity

Community Development and Social Impact

- Increase investment in Black neighborhoods by X% annually to drive community growth
- Improve quality of life indicators in Black neighborhoods by X% within X years
- Reduce incidents of racial bias and discrimination in economic settings by X% annually through targeted initiatives
- Increase the median household wealth in predominantly Black neighborhoods by X% over the [next X years] through targeted initiatives (i.e., business development, homeownership initiatives, and financial education programs)

The Business
Community



Session Attendees/Contributors

J. Averi Frost, Executive Director

Freedom Equity Inc.

Central Ohio African American Chamber of Commerce

Jill Frost, Board Chair

Central Ohio African American Chamber of Commerce

LoLo Mychael, CEO & Founder

Urban Business Development Center

Keena Smith, CEO & Founder

The Women's Center for Economic Opportunity

Chanel Norton Lee, Senior Manager of Supplier Diversity

VS&Co

Jerry Saunders, Board Chair

The Women's Center for Economic Opportunity

Renard Green, Owner

Camelot Cellars

Jennifer McKenzie, Managing Partner

Organized Synergy

Developing Shared Language and Meaning

Starting Point for Our Ever Evolving Lexicon

Wealth

Wealth is the total net worth of an individual or household, including assets like savings, investments, real estate, and other valuable possessions. It represents long-term financial security and the ability to build generational prosperity.

Scalability

Scalability refers to a business's capacity to grow and expand its operations, customer base, and revenue streams without being constrained by its current resources and infrastructure. It reflects the potential for a business to achieve significant, sustainable growth.

Impact

Impact encompasses the positive, measurable change a business or individual creates in their community, whether through job creation, wealth generation, neighborhood revitalization, or other tangible improvements to the local economy and quality of life.

Sustainability

Sustainability refers to a business's ability to maintain and grow its operations, profitability, and market position over the long term, without compromising its core values or the well-being of the community it serves.

Entrepreneurial Mindset

The entrepreneurial mindset is a set of skills, behaviors, and attitudes that enable individuals to identify and seize opportunities, take calculated risks, problem-solve, and persevere in the face of challenges to build successful, innovative businesses.